

POWER PLAY

Credited with helping Power Finance Corporation, India's largest NBFC, gain Maharatna status, Parminder Chopra is the first woman to lead it. Her 35-year experience helps as she leads PFC, that has a market capitalisation of more than ₹1 lakh crore, into newer avenues with a focus on renew-



PARMINDER CHOPRA
56, CMD, Power Finance Corporation

able energy. Chopra has a knack for good performance—she led PFC's finance division when it registered its highest net profit and net worth, and lowest non-performing assets. As PFC, the largest renewable energy financier increases funding to such projects, the onus is on Chopra to help India achieve the 500-GW renewable energy target by 2030. And going by her track record, that is another milestone she'd like to tick off. BT

— BY SURABHI



RAVNEET KAUR
60, Chairperson, Competition Commission of India

Competition Guardian

SOFT SPOKEN AND with a ready smile, 60-year-old Ravneet Kaur was brought in as Chairperson in May 2023 to lead the Competition Commission of India after its previous head Ashok Kumar Gupta demitted office in October 2022. In the midst of investigating several big tech firms, and with a number of deals pending approval, Kaur has been

instrumental in clearing the logjam at India's competition watchdog. An IAS officer of the Punjab cadre (1988 batch), Kaur—who has a rich body of experience to draw upon—is also working on notifying the provisions of the Competition (Amendment) Act, 2023.

Kaur has also organised the BRICS International Cooperation Conference—that

is looking to take up issues related to the digital economy. The CCI, under her leadership, is also in the midst of finalising a number of new provisions to strengthen India's anti-trust frameworks.

What's more, the competition watchdog has launched a pan-India market study of the cement sector, which industry watchers believe will lead to stricter enforcement action. All this and more has been done in just the first six months of her tenure, and with another four and a half years left, Kaur's leadership is expected to get the country's competition regulator in shape to play a much larger role. **BT**

— BY SURABHI

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IN TECH I TRUST

SANDHYA DEVANATHAN breached the fort of big tech's boys' club in January 2023, after being appointed as VP and Head of Meta India. Since then, Devanathan has been working towards strengthening the creator economy in India through Meta's various social media platforms, and building partnerships with policymakers in the country.

Devanathan, a graduate of Faculty of Management Studies, University of Delhi, has also been appointed as a Board Observer of Jio Platforms earlier this year.

SANDHYA DEVANATHAN
46, VP and Head, Meta India

She joined Meta (earlier called Facebook) in 2016, and has helped build its Singapore and Vietnam businesses, as well as its e-commerce initiatives in Southeast Asia. Before joining big tech, Devanathan had an illustrious career as a banker with Citibank and Standard Chartered Bank. That apart, Devanathan is also recognised for her contributions towards promoting diversity and inclusivity at the workplace. Her varied interests are also apparent in the many advisory and board member roles she holds. Going forward, how she manages Meta's operations in India will be the story to watch out for. **BT**

— BY AAKANKSHA CHATURVEDI

